

Intermediate 1 — Present Perfect Continuous

Name: _____

Part A — Present Perfect Continuous: Statements (for / since)

We use the present perfect continuous for an action that started in the past and is still happening now, or that has just stopped and explains a result we can see now.

Form: Subject + have / has + been + verb-ing (+ for / since + time)

Situation: She started teaching here in 2016. She still teaches here.

PPC: She **has been teaching** here since 2016.

Situation: It started raining this morning. It is still raining.

PPC: It **has been raining** for six hours.

Situation: I am tired now. The reason is my homework.

PPC: I **have been doing** my homework all evening.

A1 — Match the halves

Match each sentence beginning (0–5) with the correct ending (a–f). Number 0 is done for you.

- | | | |
|---|---------------------------------------|---|
| 0. My hands are dirty because I... | ☒ f | a. has been raining since lunchtime. |
| 1. Ana is exhausted because she... | ☐ b | b. have been studying hard all month. |
| 2. The streets are wet because it... | ☐ c | c. have been waiting for a table for an hour. |
| 3. We are really hungry because we... | ☐ d | d. has been playing video games since seven. |
| 4. My brother's eyes are red because he... | ☐ e | e. has been working since six this morning. |
| 5. The teachers are pleased because the students... | ☐ f | f. have been fixing my bike all afternoon. |

A2 — Fill in the gaps

Choose a verb from the box and write it in the present perfect continuous. Use each verb once. Number 0 is done for you.

wait • learn • snow • save • practice • live

0. Marcos has been learning English since he was nine years old.
1. We _____ in Curitiba for twelve years.
2. It _____ in the south since Tuesday, so the roads are dangerous.
3. Carla _____ the guitar every evening this week.
4. I _____ money since January to buy a new phone.
5. My parents _____ for the bus for twenty minutes.

A3 — Rewrite with the present perfect continuous

Rewrite each sentence in the present perfect continuous, using the time expression in brackets with for or since. Number 0 is done for you.

0. She teaches at this school. (ten years) → She has been teaching at this school for ten years.

1. They play in the same band. (2019) → _____

2. I wait for your message. (all morning) → _____

3. It rains in Curitiba. (Monday) →

4. My sister studies for her exams. (three hours) →

5. We live in the same apartment. (2014) →

A4 — Find the mistakes

There are six mistakes with the present perfect continuous in the text. Number 0 is corrected for you. Find the other five and write them in the table.

This month my whole family has been extremely busy. My mother ~~has been work~~ (0 → **has been working**) extra hours at the hospital, so she usually arrives home after nine o'clock. My father have been driving her to work every morning because our car is old and he does not trust it. My two brothers has been studying for their final exams since the beginning of September, and they say their eyes hurt all the time. I have been help them a little with their English, but I am not a teacher, so my explanations are terrible. Our neighbors have been build a new garage next door, and the noise starts at seven in the morning. My grandmother is been complaining about it every single day. It has been raining almost every afternoon here in Curitiba, so nobody can relax in the garden either. Even our dog has been acting strangely, and he has been sleeping under my bed since the workers arrived. I have been waiting for a quiet weekend for three weeks now, and I think we all need one. Next month everything will be calmer, I hope, because my mother has been talking about taking a few days off and my brothers will finally finish their tests.

#	Mistake	Correction
0	has been work	has been working
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

A5 — Answer the questions

Answer with complete sentences in the present perfect continuous. Write at least 15 words for each answer. Number 0 is an example.

0. How long have you been studying English, and what have you been finding difficult lately?

I have been studying English for about six years, and lately I have been finding phrasal verbs really difficult to remember.

1. What have you been doing after school this week?

2. Which sport or hobby have you been practicing recently, and how often?

3. What has your family been doing at home on the weekends lately?

4. Which series, game or channel have you been following, and why do you like it?

5. How has the weather in Curitiba been affecting your plans this month?

Part B — Present Perfect Continuous: Questions & Negatives

To ask a question, we put *have* or *has* before the subject. To make a negative, we use *haven't* or *hasn't*. The word *been* and the *-ing* form never change.

Form: (Wh-) + have / has + subject + been + verb-ing? | Subject + haven't / hasn't + been + verb-ing

- Sentence:** Ana has been studying all afternoon.
Question: **Has** Ana **been studying** all afternoon?
Sentence: They have been waiting outside.
Negative: They **haven't been waiting** outside.
Sentence: He has been working here for a year.
Wh- Q: How long **has** he **been working** here?

B1 — Match the halves

Match each question beginning (0–5) with the correct ending (a–f). Number 0 is done for you.

- | | | |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| 0. How long have you... | ☒ f | a. been staying since they arrived? |
| 1. What has Bruno... | ☐ | b. been raining since you left home? |
| 2. Why haven't the boys... | ☐ | c. been doing on his laptop all morning? |
| 3. Has it... | ☐ | d. been feeling well this week? |
| 4. Where have your cousins... | ☐ | e. been helping with the group project? |
| 5. Hasn't Laura... | ☐ | f. been waiting outside the classroom? |

B2 — Fill in the gaps

Choose a verb from the box and complete each question or negative sentence. Use each verb once. Number 0 is done for you.

listen • feel • sleep • use • work • come

0. Rafael hasn't been sleeping well since he started his new job.
1. Julia hasn't _____ well since Friday.
2. Has Pedro _____ at the same company since 2020?
3. The twins haven't _____ to class this week.
4. Why haven't you _____ to the audio files at home?
5. How long has your sister _____ that old phone?

B3 — Questions and negatives

Rewrite each sentence as the form in brackets. Number 0 is done for you.

0. They have been waiting since ten o'clock. (question) → Have they been waiting since ten o'clock?
1. Marina has been working at the bakery. (negative) → _____
2. You have been using my charger. (question) → _____
3. It has been snowing in the south. (negative) → _____
4. The students have been practicing for two hours. (question with *How long*) → _____
5. My father has been feeling tired lately. (negative) → _____

B4 — Find the mistakes

There are six mistakes with present perfect continuous questions and negatives in the text. Number 0 is corrected for you. Find the other five and write them in the table.

Hi Lucas! I ~~haven't been write~~ (0 → **haven't been writing**) to you for weeks, so here is a very long message. Do you have been studying for the history test? I hope so, because Mrs. Lima says it will be difficult this time. I haven't been sleep very well this week, and my mother says it is because I use my phone at night. Has your brothers been playing football on Saturdays? My cousin wants to join the team, but he hasn't been train with anybody since the holidays. Where you have been going after class? I passed by the bakery on Tuesday and nobody was there. My sister hasn't been feeling well since Sunday, so we haven't been going out much at all. She hasn't been eating properly either, and my father has been cooking soup every night for her. How long has your family been living in that new apartment? My mother asks me about it every week and I never know the answer. I haven't been practicing my English much this month, so please answer in English and not in Portuguese. Write soon, because I have been waiting for news from you since August and I am starting to worry!

#	Mistake	Correction
0	haven't been write	haven't been writing
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

B5 — Answer the questions

Answer with complete sentences using questions and negatives in the present perfect continuous. Write at least 15 words for each answer. Number 0 is an example.

0. What haven't you been doing enough of this month, and why not?

I haven't been reading enough in English this month because I have been spending all my free time playing games online.

1. What have your classmates been talking about a lot recently?

2. Which subject haven't you been enjoying this semester, and what has been making it difficult?

3. How long has your best friend been studying at this school, and how did you meet?

4. What has your family been planning for the end of the year?

5. Why haven't you been relaxing as much as you would like lately?

Answer Key — Teacher's Copy

Part A — Present Perfect Continuous: Statements

A1: 0-f, 1-e, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d, 5-b

A2:

1. have been living
2. has been snowing
3. has been practicing
4. have been saving
5. have been waiting

A3:

1. They have been playing in the same band since 2019.
2. I have been waiting for your message all morning.
3. It has been raining in Curitiba since Monday.
4. My sister has been studying for her exams for three hours.
5. We have been living in the same apartment since 2014.

A4:

1. "My father have been driving" → has been driving
2. "My two brothers has been studying" → have been studying
3. "I have been help them" → have been helping
4. "have been build a new garage" → have been building
5. "My grandmother is been complaining" → has been complaining

A5: Open answers. Accept any truthful answer of 15+ words that uses the present perfect continuous correctly (have/has + been + -ing).

Part B — Present Perfect Continuous: Questions & Negatives

B1: 0-f, 1-c, 2-e, 3-b, 4-a, 5-d

B2:

1. been feeling
2. been working
3. been coming
4. been listening
5. been using

B3:

1. Marina hasn't been working at the bakery.
2. Have you been using my charger?
3. It hasn't been snowing in the south.
4. How long have the students been practicing?
5. My father hasn't been feeling tired lately.

B4:

1. "Do you have been studying" → Have you been studying
2. "I haven't been sleep" → haven't been sleeping
3. "Has your brothers been playing" → Have your brothers been playing
4. "he hasn't been train" → hasn't been training
5. "Where you have been going" → Where have you been going

B5: Open answers. Accept any truthful answer of 15+ words with correct question or negative forms (haven't/hasn't + been + -ing).